

1 ENGROSSED SENATE
2 CONCURRENT
3 RESOLUTION NO. 20

By: Pugh of the Senate

and

Kerbs of the House

5
6 A Concurrent Resolution congratulating the YMCA on
7 175 years of service; recognizing its role in
8 strengthening communities; commending its staff and
9 volunteers; and encouraging continued efforts to
10 promote well-being and connection.

11 WHEREAS, the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) marks its
12 175th anniversary, having been founded in the United States by
13 Thomas Valentine Sullivan in Boston on December 29, 1851, with a
14 mission to put Christian principles into practice by building a
15 healthy spirit, mind, and body for all; and

16 WHEREAS, the YMCA has continually adapted to meet the evolving
17 needs of American communities, strengthening society by bringing
18 people together, fostering relationships, and creating a sense of
19 belonging; and

20 WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy includes providing safe housing
21 during the Industrial Revolution, pioneering the first night school
22 and English as a Second Language classes, inventing basketball, and
23 delivering the first group swim lessons; and
24

1 WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy also includes establishing the Youth
2 and Government program, serving as the birthplace of Father's Day,
3 and becoming the nation's leading nonprofit provider of child care
4 and after-school programs to support working families; and

5 WHEREAS, today nearly 2,600 YMCAs serve more than 10,000
6 communities, with more than 300,000 staff and 350,000 volunteers
7 delivering essential programs to over 17 million people annually;
8 and

9 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma Alliance of YMCAs amplifies the work of
10 nine independent YMCAs through a shared commitment to strengthening
11 communities by connecting people to their potential, purpose, and
12 each other; and

13 WHEREAS, the YMCA of Greater Oklahoma City, founded in 1889 and
14 one of the earliest civic organizations formed after the Land Run,
15 was the first YMCA in Oklahoma; and

16 WHEREAS, Oklahoma YMCAs have more than 3,600 staff and nearly
17 7,000 volunteers providing essential programs and services to 37
18 communities; and

19 WHEREAS, the YMCA is a leader in aquatics (water safety and swim
20 lessons), child care, youth sports, meal programs, and health and
21 wellness initiatives, and is the largest provider of fitness
22 programs for older adults; and

23 WHEREAS, the YMCA creates welcoming spaces for people of all
24 ages, backgrounds, and abilities.

1 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
2 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
3 CONCURRING THEREIN:

4 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature congratulates and expresses
5 appreciation to the YMCA for 175 years of service to the nation.

6 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature recognizes the YMCA's role in
7 responding to community needs, fostering relationships, and building
8 a sense of belonging.

9 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature commends the staff and volunteers
10 who create connected communities and advance the YMCA's mission.

11 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature encourages continued support for
12 the efforts to address social isolation and loneliness by creating
13 places that promote well-being and help people build relationships
14 and thrive.

15 Adopted by the Senate the 16th day of April, 2026.

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17 _____
18 Presiding Officer of the Senate

19 Adopted by the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
20 2026.

21
22 _____
23 Presiding Officer of the House
24 of Representatives